Persist Week of February 23, 2026

REMINDER: Persist is no longer accessible through ATOM. To continue using Persist, you must log in through our new app. If you have not received your login instructions or are experiencing any issues, please contact us at **support@functional-bodybuilding.com**

We will continue to send a PDF version of training in our Persist only weekly newsletters.
This document may be created in advance of edits to the ongoing tracks in Persist, so while we try to minimize these discrepancies as much as possible, the version displayed in our app is always the most up to date. As always, please reach out using the chat bubble in our FBB app or on our website at https://functional-bodybuilding.com if you have any questions about the programming. It may be helpful to look over the week ahead to make sure your questions are all answered in time for your workout.

Pump Lift 5x
- Monday February 23, 2026
- Tuesday February 24, 2026
- Wednesday February 25, 2026
- Thursday February 26, 2026
- Friday February 27, 2026
- Saturday February 28, 2026
- Sunday March 1, 2026

Pump Lift 4x
- Monday February 23, 2026
- Tuesday February 24, 2026
- Wednesday February 25, 2026
- Thursday February 26, 2026
- Friday February 27, 2026
- Saturday February 28, 2026
- Sunday March 1, 2026

Pump Lift 3x
- Monday February 23, 2026
- Tuesday February 24, 2026
- Wednesday February 25, 2026
- Thursday February 26, 2026
- Friday February 27, 2026
- Saturday February 28, 2026
- Sunday March 1, 2026

- Pump Condition 5x
  - Monday February 23, 2026
  - Tuesday February 24, 2026
  - Wednesday February 25, 2026
  - Thursday February 26, 2026
  - Friday February 27, 2026
  - Saturday February 28, 2026
  - Sunday March 1, 2026
- Pump Condition 4x
  - Monday February 23, 2026
  - Tuesday February 24, 2026
  - Wednesday February 25, 2026
  - Thursday February 26, 2026
  - Friday February 27, 2026
  - Saturday February 28, 2026
  - Sunday March 1, 2026
- Pump Condition 3x
  - Monday February 23, 2026
  - Tuesday February 24, 2026
  - Wednesday February 25, 2026
  - Thursday February 26, 2026
  - Friday February 27, 2026
  - Saturday February 28, 2026
  - Sunday March 1, 2026
- Perform
  - Monday February 23, 2026
  - Tuesday February 24, 2026
  - Wednesday February 25, 2026
  - Thursday February 26, 2026
  - Friday February 27, 2026
  - Saturday February 28, 2026
  - Sunday March 1, 2026
- Minimalist
  - Monday February 23, 2026
  - Tuesday February 24, 2026
  - Wednesday February 25, 2026
  - Thursday February 26, 2026

Friday February 27, 2026
Saturday February 28, 2026
Sunday March 1, 2026

Pump Lift 5x

Monday February 23, 2026

Week 3 Day 1 - Persist PUMP LIFT 5x

A) Daily Focus Notes: Pull Up Negative Benefits
Tension is one of the main terms used when people talk about muscle growth - for good reason. And using weights to overload your Pull Up negatives leads to exactly this - HIGH MUSCLE TENSION. Fight to go slowly down during each negative, and feel the high muscular tension in the biceps and lats.
Short on Time? Remove Finisher.

B) Warm Up (8 min)
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
3 Sets
15 sec Cardio Sprint
Single Leg Hand Support DB RDL; 6-8 reps/side
Body Row; 12-15 reps

C) Strength Intensity 1 (15 min):
Sumo Deadlift
6 Working Sets; rest 60-75 sec between sets
Warm-Up Set - 6 reps @ 21X1 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 4 reps @ 21X1 - Moderate
Warm-Up Set - 3 reps @ 21X1 - Moderate
Warm-Up Set - 3 reps @ 21X1 - Harder
Working Set 1-6: 3 reps @ 21X1 - RPE 6-8
Loading Note:
Another classic strength training rep scheme. This 6x3 will be performed around 80% of your 1RM, about 5% higher than week 1 weights. It is important to stick close to this percentage as the rest is shorter and the goal of this session is to keep quality and speed high throughout all 18 reps. The goal is not to build to a 3 rep max. Select a weight that is about an RPE 6-7 on the first working set, and then keep this weight the same for all 6 sets. As sets go on, the fatigue accumulated will

increase the difficulty and thus RPE (Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure).

D) Strength Intensity 2 (12 min):
Pendlay Row
3 Working Sets; rest 2 minutes
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 21X1 - Easy
Working Set 1 - 9 @ 21X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 7 @ 21X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 5 @ 21X1 - RPE 9
Loading Note:
Increase weight each set. The reps have decreased from Week 1, allowing for an increase in weight.

E) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
GHD Hip Extension or 45 Degree Hypers; 15 reps @30X0
rest 30-60 sec
Supinated Pull Up Negative; 4 reps @51A1 (see loading note)
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1
Loading Note:
Weight may be added for the GHD Hip Extension or 45 Degree hyper, but aim to keep the technique perfect and tempo controlled. If you do not have access to either of these, you may perform the 45-degree alternative in the exercises swap section.
For the Pull Up Negative, the tempo is a 1 sec pause at the top and bottom with 5 second negative. Make sure that you have a box or bench near the Pull Up bar, so you can step or jump back up to the top position (A = Assist). The goal is to overload with more weight than you can normally do a Pull Up with. For some this may be just bodyweight, and for others you may have to add up to half your bodyweight.

F) Finisher (8 min):
2-3 sets
1 1/4 DB Bicep Curl; 6-10 reps
rest 30 sec
Farmers Walk; 50m
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note: Aim for each set to be close to failure.

G) Cooldown (5 min)
1-2 sets

Lumbar Roll to Pancake Stretch; 5 reps with 5 sec stretch
Single Arm Wall Prayer Stretch x 30 sec/side
Pigeon Stretch; 30-60 sec/side

Tuesday February 24, 2026

Week 3 Day 2 - Persist PUMP LIFT 5x

A) Daily Focus Notes: Supporting Player Shoulder Muscles
If you want a big bench, stronger pressing, and more Pull Ups, then work on improving the muscles that support your shoulders as well as your shoulders directly. The Strength Balance section today targets some of these supporting muscles with the goal of bringing more balance and capacity to the entire area.
Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance

B) Warmup (8 min)
3 Rounds
90 sec Cardio of Choice
Half Kneeling DB Windmill; 5 reps/side
Banded Face Pull; 15-20 reps

C) Strength Intensity 1 (15 min):
Strict Press
4 Working Sets; rest 90 sec
Warm-Up Set - 8 reps @ 21X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 8 reps @ 21X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 8 reps @ 21X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 8 reps @ 21X1 - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - Max Unbroken reps @ 20X0 - RPE 10 (NO PAUSES - Same weight as Set 3)
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (12 min):
Single Arm DB Bench Press
3 Working Sets; rest 90 sec
Warm-Up Set - 8 reps/side @ 21X1 - Easy
Working Set 1 - 8 reps/side @ 21X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 8 reps/side @ 21X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - Max Unbroken reps @ 20X0 - RPE 10 (NO PAUSES once you start each arm - Drop back to same weight as Set 1)

E) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
Flat Bench DB Fly; 10-12 reps @20X0
rest 30-60 sec
DB Full Raise; 10-12 reps @20X0
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1
Loading Note:
Aim for each set to be close to failure.

F) Finisher (6-8 min):
Cable Tricep Pushdown or Narrow Grip Tricep Push Ups; 50 reps in as few sets as possible.
Loading Note:
Select a weight that is about a 15 rep max. Each time you come close to failure, take a brief rest period, then resume when you are ready until you complete all 50 reps.
*If you do not have access to a Cable Machine, Perform 50 Narrow Grip Tricep Push Ups in as few sets as possible.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Sidelying 90/90 Thoracic Rotation; 5 reps/side
Seated Shoulder Extension Stretch; 30 sec
Passive Hang; 30 sec

Wednesday February 25, 2026

Week 3 Day 3 - Persist PUMP LIFT 5x

A) Daily Focus Notes: Strength Balance
Today's workout focuses on balance around the knee. In this training block we use KOT (Knee Over Toe) Split Squats and isolated calf work to target the muscles that directly support the knee. Of course, nicer calves are a bonus on top!
Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance or Finisher.

B) Warmup (8 min)
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
3 Sets
Curtsy Step Down; 6 reps/side
Single Leg Hip Thrust; 10 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity 1 (15 min):
Back Squat
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 minutes
Warm-Up Set - 5 reps @ 22X1 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 4 reps @ 33X1 - Easy
Working Set 1 - 3 @ 33X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 3 @ 33X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 3 @ 33X1 - RPE 9

Loading Note:

Prioritize a quality pause and bottom position during all sets today. For this tempo in your working sets, you'll take 3 seconds to get down into the bottom position, hold tight for 3 seconds at the bottom, explode up (X), then pause for 1 second at the top. The reps have decreased, but the time under tension (tempo) has increased. RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (12 min):
1 1/4 Hip Thrust
3 Working Sets; rest 2 minutes
Warm-Up Set - 7 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 7 @ 20X0 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 7 @ 20X0 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 7 @ 20X0 - RPE 9

Loading Note:

The 1/4 rep towards the top forces a lot of tension in the glutes and hamstrings and emphasizes a strong lockout of hip extension. The reps have decreased from Week 1, allowing for an increase in weight.

E) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
Alternating Suitcase KOT Forward Elevated Lunge; 6 reps/side @21X1
rest 30-60 sec
Hand Support Suitcase Single Leg Calf Raise; 10-12 reps/side @20X0
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1

Loading Note:

Perform the KOT (Knee Over Toe) Lunge for quality not load. This exercise is a great expression of full range of motion in the lower body. Use it to continue to improve your flexibility. Aim for close to failure with each set of calf raises.

F) Finisher (4-8 min):

2-3 sets
Forearm Plank; 30-60 sec
Side Plank; 15-30 sec/side
Hollow Body Hold; 15-30 sec
rest 90 sec between sets
Loading Note:
*Minimal rest between exercises.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Slantboard Jefferson Pulse; 30 sec
Half Kneeling Hip Flexor Stretch; 30 sec/side
Shinbox Heel Touch; 5 reps/side

Thursday February 26, 2026

Week 3 Day 4 - Persist PUMP LIFT 5x

A) Active Recovery Work (40 min):
Part 1: 20 min timer (continuous movement):
200m Row or Jog
then stop and do the following:
20 sec Side Plank Right
20 sec Side Plank Left
4 Standing KB or Bodyweight Windmill Right
4 Standing KB or Bodyweight Windmill Left
*return to Row or Jog and repeat
then
Part 2: 20 min timer (continuous movement):
200m Row or Jog
then stop and do the following:
10 Underswitch to Crab Reach
15m Quadruped Crawl
20sec Bent Hollow Hold
*return to Row or Jog and repeat

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):
Thoracic Mobility
Segmented Cat Cow x 5 reps
Childs Pose Lat Stretch x 30 sec/side

Sidelying Thoracic Rotation x 5 reps/side with 5 sec hold
T Spine Can Opener x 1-2 min
Banded Shoulder Extension x 1 min
Active Banded Shoulder Extension x 5 reps
Yoga Push Up x 5 reps

Friday February 27, 2026

Week 3 Day 5 - Persist PUMP LIFT 5x

A) Daily Focus Notes: Bench for Triceps
The Bench Press is often viewed as a chest exercise, but happens to be one of the best tricep exercises you can do. The Triceps are forced to go through a large range of motion with a lot of weight, even while being supported by the pecs. The Close-Grip Bench Press is a subtle variation that forces even a little more tricep and less chest. Place your hands straight out from your shoulders, as if you were imitating a zombie.
Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance or Finisher.

B) Warmup (8 min)
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
3 Sets
15 sec Cardio Sprint
Push Up With Shoulder Tap; 4-5 reps/side
Supinated Pull Up Isometric; 10 sec

C) Strength Intensity 1 (15 min):
1 1/4 Close-Grip Bench Press
4 Working Sets; rest 2 minutes
Warm-Up Set - 5 reps @ 20X1 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 5 reps @ 20X1 - Easy
Working Set 1 - 5 @ 20X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 5 @ 20X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 5 @ 20X1 - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - Remove the 1/4 Rep and perform Max reps of Close-Grip Bench Press @ Set 1 weight. RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (12 min):
Every 60sec x 12 Sets
Odd Minutes - Weighted Strict Bar Dip x 4-6 reps @ 20X0

Even Minutes - Weighted Strict Supinated Pull Up x 4-6 reps @ 20X0
Loading Note:
The first three sets should be lighter or easier than the last three sets. Finish the last 1-2 sets at RPE 9/10.

E) Strength Balance (10 min):
3 sets
Barbell Skullcrusher; 10 reps @20X0
rest 30 sec
Reverse Barbell Curl; 10 reps @20X0
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1
Loading Note:
Aim for each set to be close to failure.

F) Finisher (6-8 min):
2-3 sets
DB Lateral Raise; 12-15 reps @30X0
rest 15 sec
Cable or Banded Face Pull; 12-15 reps @30X0
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Aim for each set to be close to failure.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Forward Shoulder Wall Circles; 10 reps/side
Banded Shoulder Flexion Stretch; 30 sec
Banded Shoulder Extension Stretch; 30 sec

Saturday February 28, 2026

Week 3 Day 6 - Persist PUMP LIFT 5x

A) Daily Focus Notes: Bulletproof Hamstrings
The hamstrings help us in a lot of ways, but one of them is to support how your knees bend and extend. The hamstring curl progression in the Strength Balance of today's training is one of many ways we will target the hamstrings throughout this week of training - so no area of your body goes untouched.
Short on Time? Perform 2 sets of Strength Intensity 1.

B) Warmup (8 min)
3 Rounds
90 sec Cardio of Choice
Forward Lunge; 6/side
Goblet Good Morning; 10 reps

C) Strength Intensity Giant Set (18 min):
4 sets
Goblet Cyclist Squat; 6-8 reps @22X1 Tempo
rest 30 sec
Single Leg Hand Support DB RDL; 5-7 reps/side @30X0
rest 30 sec
Single Arm DB Suitcase Drop Lunge; 10 reps/side
rest 2 min and back to 1.
Loading Note:
For this lower body giant set, the goal is to use one DB for each set. Perform 1 warmup set to determine starting weight. Aim for the first set to be around RPE 7. Increase weight each set with the goal of an increasing RPE. For the Drop Lunge, perform all reps on one side before switching to the other side. RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
Gliding Hamstring Curl; 10 reps @30X0
rest 30 sec
Ring Assisted Cossack Squat; 8-10 reps/side @20X0
rest 2 min and back to 1.
Loading Note:
For the Ring Assisted Cossack Squat, you may hold onto any object that will act as a counterbalance and upper body support to keep the movement controlled and high quality. Perform a few reps of each movement to determine starting set up. Aim for each set to be RPE 8+.

E) Finisher (6-8 min):
2-3 sets
Bent Knee Copenhagen Raise; 8-12 reps/side
rest 15 sec
Weighted Hanging Knee Tuck; 8-12 reps
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:

The goal of this finisher is to build strength in some of the smaller muscles around the pelvis and the lower abdominals. Keep quality high - you do not need to go to failure for a great stimulus in these muscles.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Half Split Hip Hinge; 6-8 reps/side
Weighted Ankle Stretch; 30 sec/side
Bottom of Squat Hold; 30 sec

Sunday March 1, 2026

Week 3 Day 7 - Persist PUMP LIFT 5x

The 3/60/10 Formula

If you're training 5 days per week and thriving, keep at it. We made the 5 day tracks in Persist for people who love to be in the gym.

If that's not you, guess what - it's not me right now either.

The 3/60/10 Formula is a general guideline that works great for most people for exactly how much movement, and what kind, you need to look good and move well. I've been following it for months and it works a treat.

3 days in the gym per week (Persist PUMP LIFT or PUMP CONDITION was made for this)

60 minutes of cardio total per week (The conditioning workouts in Persist, the Active Recovery days, the 30/30 or Aerobic 40 cardio workouts you can find in the Additional Resources section of the app, or any cardio you like - all at once or broken up throughout the week.)

10k steps per day (Work up to it gradually if you're not there already.)

With this formula I recover well and hit the gym HARD. I stay active every day. And you can too.

If you've been burning the candle at both ends and considering dropping down a training day or two, you have my full permission to try it. Message us any time if you need some support.

With love,

Marcus

Pump Lift 4x

Monday February 23, 2026

Week 3 Day 1 - Persist PUMP LIFT 4x

Daily Focus Notes: Supporting Player Shoulder Muscles
If you want a big bench, stronger pressing, and more Pull Ups, then work on improving the muscles that support your shoulders as well as your shoulders directly. The Strength Balance section today targets some of these supporting muscles with the goal of bringing more balance and capacity to the entire area.
Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance

Warmup (8 min):
3 Rounds
90 sec Cardio of Choice
Half Kneeling DB Windmill; 5 reps/side
Banded Face Pull; 15-20 reps
Strength Intensity 1 (15 min):

Strict Press
4 Working Sets; rest 90 sec
Warm-Up Set - 8 reps @ 21X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 8 reps @ 21X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 8 reps @ 21X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 8 reps @ 21X1 - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - Max Unbroken reps @ 20X0 - RPE 10 (NO PAUSES - Same weight as Set 3)
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

Strength Intensity 2 (12 min):
Single Arm DB Bench Press
3 Working Sets; rest 90 sec
Warm-Up Set - 8 reps/side @ 21X1 - Easy
Working Set 1 - 8 reps/side @ 21X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 8 reps/side @ 21X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - Max Unbroken reps @ 20X0 - RPE 10 (NO PAUSES once you start each arm - Drop back to same weight as Set 1)

Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
Flat Bench DB Fly; 10-12 reps @20X0
rest 30-60 sec
DB Full Raise; 10-12 reps @20X0
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1
Loading Note:
Aim for each set to be close to failure.

Finisher (6-8 min):
Cable Tricep Pushdown or Narrow Grip Tricep Push ups; 50 reps in as few sets as possible.
Loading Note:
Select a weight that is about a 15 rep max. Each time you come close to failure, take a brief rest period, then resume when you are ready until you complete all 50 reps.
*If you do not have access to a Cable Machine, Perform 50 Narrow Grip Tricep Push ups in as few sets as possible.

Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Sidelying 90/90 Thoracic Rotation; 5 reps/side
Seated Shoulder Extension Stretch; 30 sec
Passive Hang; 30 sec

Tuesday February 24, 2026

Week 3 Day 2 - Persist PUMP LIFT 4x

Daily Focus Notes: Strength Balance Superset
Today's superset is a combination of lower body exercises that are each manageable on their own. But when you combine them, they offer a strong, yet safe stimulus for the lower body.
Short on Time? Remove Finisher.

Warmup (8 min):
3 Rounds
90 sec Cardio of Choice
Forward Lunge; 6/side
Goblet Good Morning; 10 reps

Strength Intensity 1 (15 min):

Sumo Deadlift
6 Working Sets; rest 60-75 sec between sets
Warm-Up Set - 6 reps @ 21X1 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 4 reps @ 21X1 - Moderate
Warm-Up Set - 3 reps @ 21X1 - Moderate
Warm-Up Set - 3 reps @ 21X1 - Harder
Working Set 1-6: 3 reps @ 21X1 - RPE 6-8
Loading Note:
Another classic strength training rep scheme. This 6x3 will be performed around 80% of your 1RM, about 5% higher than week 1 weights. It is important to stick close to this percentage as the rest is shorter and the goal of this session is to keep quality and speed high throughout all 18 reps. The goal is not to build to a 3 rep max. Select a weight that is about an RPE 6-7 on the first working set, and then keep this weight the same for all 6 sets. As sets go on, the fatigue accumulated will increase the difficulty and thus RPE (Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure).

Strength Intensity 2 (12 min):
Pendlay Row
3 Working Sets; rest 2 minutes
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 21X1 - Easy
Working Set 1 - 9 @ 21X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 7 @ 21X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 5 @ 21X1 - RPE 9
Loading Note:
Increase weight each set. The reps have decreased from Week 1, allowing for an increase in weight.

Strength Balance (15 min):
3 sets
Goblet Cyclist Squat; 8 reps @33X1
rest 30 sec
Single Arm DB Suitcase Drop Lunge; 10 reps/side
rest 2 min and back to 1.
Loading Note:
For this lower body superset, the goal is to use one DB for each set. Perform 1 warmup set to determine starting weight. Aim for the first set to be around RPE 7. Increase weight each set with the goal of an increasing RPE. For the Drop Lunge, perform all reps on one side before switching to the other side.

Finisher (6-8 min):

2-3 sets
Bent Knee Copenhagen Raise; 8-12 reps/side
rest 15 sec
Weighted Hanging Knee Tuck; 8-12 reps
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
The goal of this finisher is to build strength in some of the smaller muscles around the pelvis and the lower abdominals. Keep quality high - you do not need to go to failure for a great stimulus in these muscles.

Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Half Split Hip Hinge; 6-8 reps/side
Weighted Ankle Stretch; 30 sec/side
Bottom of Squat Hold; 30 sec

Wednesday February 25, 2026

Week 3 Day 3 - Persist PUMP LIFT 4x

A) Active Recovery Work (30 min):
Goal: Complete 30 minutes of low-intensity steady-state movement today. You can get out for a 30-minute walk, hike on some moderate terrain, or if you like to bike or swim, have at it. Or try a 30/30 Cardio workout in the Additional Resources section of the app.

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):
Thoracic Mobility
Segmented Cat Cow x 5 reps
Childs Pose Lat Stretch x 30 sec/side
Sidelying Thoracic Rotation x 5 reps/side with 5 sec hold
T Spine Can Opener x 1-2 min
Banded Shoulder Extension x 1 min
Active Banded Shoulder Extension x 5 reps
Yoga Pushup x 5 reps

Thursday February 26, 2026

Week 3 Day 4 - Persist PUMP LIFT 4x

Daily Focus Notes: Bench for Triceps

The Bench Press is often viewed as a chest exercise, but happens to be one of the best tricep exercises you can do. The Triceps are forced to go through a large range of motion with a lot of weight, even while being supported by the pecs. The Close-Grip Bench Press is a subtle variation that forces even a little more tricep and less chest. Place your hands just slightly inside shoulder width.
Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance or Finisher.

Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
3 Sets
15 sec Cardio Sprint
Push Up With Shoulder Tap; 4-5 reps/side
Supinated pull up Isometric; 10 sec

Strength Intensity 1 (15 min):
1 1/4 Close-Grip Bench Press
4 Working Sets; rest 2 minutes
Warm-Up Set - 5 reps @ 20X1 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 5 reps @ 20X1 - Easy
Working Set 1 - 5 @ 20X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 5 @ 20X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 5 @ 20X1 - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - Remove the 1/4 Rep and perform Max reps of Close-Grip Bench Press @ Set 1 weight.
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

Strength Intensity 2 (12 min):
Every 60sec x 12 Sets
Odd Minutes - Weighted Strict Bar Dip x 4-6 reps @ 20X0
Even Minutes - Weighted Strict Supinated Pull Up x 4-6 reps @ 20X0
Loading Note:
The first three sets should be lighter or easier than the last three sets. Finish the last 1-2 sets at RPE 9/10.

Strength Balance (10 min):
3 sets
Barbell Skullcrusher; 10 reps @20X0
rest 30 sec

Reverse Barbell Curl; 10 reps @20X0
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1
Loading Note:
Aim for each set to be close to failure.

Finisher (6-8 min):
2-3 sets
DB Lateral Raise; 12-15 reps @30X0
rest 15 sec
Cable or Banded Face Pull; 12-15 reps @30X0
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Aim for each set to be close to failure.

Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Forward Shoulder Wall Circles; 10 reps/side
Banded Shoulder Flexion Stretch; 30 sec
Banded Shoulder Extension Stretch; 30 sec

Friday February 27, 2026

Week 3 Day 5 - Persist PUMP LIFT 4x

Daily Focus Notes: Strength Balance
Today's workout focuses on balance around the knee. In this training block we use KOT (Knee Over Toe) Split Squats and isolated calf work to target the muscles that directly support the knee. Of course, nicer calves are a bonus on top!
Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance or Finisher.

Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
3 Sets
Curtsy Step Down; 6 reps/side
Single Leg Hip Thrust; 10 reps/side

Strength Intensity 1 (15 min):
Back Squat
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 minutes

Warm-Up Set - 5 reps @ 22X1 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 4 reps @ 33X1 - Easy
Working Set 1 - 3 @ 33X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 3 @ 33X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 3 @ 33X1 - RPE 9

Loading Note:

Prioritize a quality pause and bottom position during all sets today. For this tempo, you'll take 3 seconds to get down into the bottom position, hold tight for 3 seconds at the bottom, explode up (X), then pause for 1 second at the top. The reps have decreased, but the time under tension (tempo) has increased. RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

Strength Intensity 2 (12 min):
1 1/4 Hip Thrust
3 Working Sets; rest 2 minutes
Warm-Up Set - 7 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 7 @ 20X0 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 7 @ 20X0 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 7 @ 20X0 - RPE 9

Loading Note:

The 1/4 rep towards the top forces a lot of tension in the glutes and hamstrings and emphasizes a strong lockout of hip extension. The reps have decreased from Week 1, allowing for an increase in weight.

Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
Alternating Suitcase KOT Forward Elevated Lunge; 6 reps/side @21X1
rest 30-60 sec
Hand Support Suitcase Single Leg Calf Raise; 10-12 reps/side @20X0
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1

Loading Note:

Perform the KOT (Knee Over Toe) Lunge for quality not load. This exercise is a great expression of full range of motion in the lower body. Use it to continue to improve your flexibility. Aim for close to failure with each set of calf raises.

Finisher (4-8 min):
2-3 sets
Forearm Plank; 30-60 sec
Side Plank; 15-30 sec/side
Hollow Body Hold; 15-30 sec

rest 90 sec between sets
Loading Note:
*Minimal rest between exercises.

Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Slantboard Jefferson Pulse; 30 sec
Half Kneeling Hip Flexor Stretch; 30 sec/side
Shinbox Heel Touch; 5 reps/side

Saturday February 28, 2026

Week 3 Day 6 - Persist PUMP LIFT 4x

Active Recovery Work (40 min):
Part 1: 20 min timer (continuous movement):
200m Row or Jog
then stop and do the following:
20 sec Side Plank Right
20 sec Side Plank Left
4 Standing KB or Bodyweight Windmill Right
4 Standing KB or Bodyweight Windmill Left
*return to Row or Jog and repeat
then
Part 2: 20 min timer (continuous movement):
200m Row or Jog
then stop and do the following:
10 Underswitch to Crab Reach
15m Quadruped Crawl
20sec Bent Hollow Hold
*return to Row or Jog and repeat

PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10-20 min):
Hip Internal Rotation
Hip Sleeper Stretch x 1-2 min/side
Shinbox Hip IR Stretch x 1-2 min/side
Shinbox Active Hip IR Liftoff x 10 reps/side
Half Kneeling Weight Shift x 10 reps/side
Squat Hip Rotations x 10 reps
Supine Active Hip Internal Rotation x 5-10 reps/side

Sunday March 1, 2026

Week 3 Day 7 - Persist PUMP LIFT 4x

The 3/60/10 Formula

If you're training 5 days per week and thriving, keep at it. We made the 5 day tracks in Persist for people who love to be in the gym.

If that's not you, guess what - it's not me right now either.

The 3/60/10 Formula is a general guideline that works great for most people for exactly how much movement, and what kind, you need to look good and move well. I've been following it for months and it works a treat.

3 days in the gym per week (Persist PUMP LIFT or PUMP CONDITION was made for this)

60 minutes of cardio total per week (The conditioning workouts in Persist, the Active Recovery days, the 30/30 or Aerobic 40 cardio workouts you can find in the Additional Resources section of the app, or any cardio you like - all at once or broken up throughout the week.)

10k steps per day (Work up to it gradually if you're not there already.)

With this formula I recover well and hit the gym HARD. I stay active every day. And you can too.

If you've been burning the candle at both ends and considering dropping down a training day or two, you have my full permission to try it. Message us any time if you need some support.

With love,
Marcus

Pump Lift 3x

Monday February 23, 2026

Week 3 Day 1 - Persist PUMP LIFT 3x

A) Daily Focus Notes: Vertical Pressing

Throughout this training cycle, you'll see three different vertical pressing movements: the Landmine Press, Filly Press, and Strict Press. Each one explores different parts of the shoulder - keeping this movement pattern fresh, while avoiding overuse.
Short on Time? Remove Finisher.

B) Warm Up (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
3 Sets
15 sec Cardio Sprint
Single Leg Hand Support DB RDL; 6-8 reps/side
Body Row; 12-15 reps

C) Strength Intensity 1 (15 min):
Sumo Deadlift
6 Working Sets; rest 60-75 sec between sets
Warm-Up Set - 6 reps @ 21X1 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 4 reps @ 21X1 - Moderate
Warm-Up Set - 3 reps @ 21X1 - Moderate
Warm-Up Set - 3 reps @ 21X1 - Harder
Working Set 1-6: 3 reps @ 21X1 - RPE 6-8
Loading Note:
Another classic strength training rep scheme. This 6x3 will be performed around 80% of your 1RM, about 5% higher than week 1 weights. It is important to stick close to this percentage as the rest is shorter and the goal of this session is to keep quality and speed high throughout all 18 reps. The goal is not to build to a 3 rep max. Select a weight that is about an RPE 6-7 on the first working set, and then keep this weight the same for all 6 sets. As sets go on, the fatigue accumulated will increase the difficulty and thus RPE (Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure).

D) Strength Intensity 2 (15 min):
Strict Press
4 Working Sets; rest 90 sec
Warm-Up Set - 8 reps @ 21X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 8 reps @ 21X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 8 reps @ 21X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 8 reps @ 21X1 - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - Max Unbroken reps @ 20X0 - RPE 10 (NO PAUSES - Same weight as Set 3)
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

E) Strength Balance (15 min):
3 sets
Goblet Cyclist Squat; 8 reps @33X1
rest 30 sec
Single Arm DB Suitcase Drop Lunge; 10 reps/side
rest 2 min and back to 1.
Loading Note:
For this lower body superset, the goal is to use one DB for each set. Perform 1 warmup set to determine starting weight. Aim for the first set to be around RPE 7. Increase weight each set with the goal of an increasing RPE. For the Drop Lunge, perform all reps on one side before switching to the other side.

F) Finisher (4-8 min):
2-3 sets
Forearm Plank; 30-60 sec
Side Plank; 15-30 sec/side
Hollow Body Hold; 15-30 sec
rest 90 sec between sets
Loading Note:
*Minimal rest between exercises.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Lumbar Roll to Pancake Stretch; 5 reps with 5 sec stretch
Single Arm Wall Prayer Stretch x 30 sec/side
Pigeon Stretch; 30-60 sec/side

Tuesday February 24, 2026

Week 3 Day 2 - Persist PUMP LIFT 3x

A) Active Recovery Work (30 min):
Goal: Complete 30 minutes of low-intensity steady-state movement today. You can get out for a 30-minute walk, hike on some moderate terrain, or if you like to bike or swim, have at it.

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):
Thoracic Mobility
Segmented Cat Cow x 5 reps
Childs Pose Lat Stretch x 30 sec/side

Sidelying Thoracic Rotation x 5 reps/side with 5 sec hold
T Spine Can Opener x 1-2 min
Banded Shoulder Extension x 1 min
Active Banded Shoulder Extension x 5 reps
Yoga Pushup x 5 reps

Wednesday February 25, 2026

Week 3 Day 3 - Persist PUMP LIFT 3x

A) Daily Focus Notes: Bench for Triceps
The Bench Press is often viewed as a chest exercise, but happens to be one of the best tricep exercises you can do. The Triceps are forced to go through a large range of motion with a lot of weight, even while being supported by the pecs. The Close-Grip Bench Press is a subtle variation that forces even a little more tricep and less chest. Place your hands just slightly inside shoulder width.
Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance or Finisher.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
3 Sets
15 sec Cardio Sprint
Push Up With Shoulder Tap; 4-5 reps/side
Supinated Pull Up Isometric; 10 sec

C) Strength Intensity 1 (15 min):
1 1/4 Close-Grip Bench Press
4 Working Sets; rest 2 minutes
Warm-Up Set - 5 reps @ 20X1 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 5 reps @ 20X1 - Easy
Working Set 1 - 5 @ 20X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 5 @ 20X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 5 @ 20X1 - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - Remove the 1/4 Rep and perform Max reps of Close-Grip Bench Press @ Set 1 weight. RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (12 min):
1 1/4 Hip Thrust
3 Working Sets; rest 2 minutes

Warm-Up Set - 7 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 7 @ 20X0 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 7 @ 20X0 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 7 @ 20X0 - RPE 9
Loading Note:
The 1/4 rep towards the top forces a lot of tension in the glutes and hamstrings and emphasizes a strong lockout of hip extension. The reps have decreased from Week 1, allowing for an increase in weight.

E) Strength Balance (10 min):
3 sets
Barbell Skullcrusher; 10 reps @20X0
rest 30 sec
Reverse Barbell Curl; 10 reps @20X0
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1
Loading Note:
Aim for each set to be close to failure.

F) Finisher (6-8 min):
2-3 sets
DB Lateral Raise; 12-15 reps @30X0
rest 15 sec
Cable or Banded Face Pull; 12-15 reps @30X0
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Aim for each set to be close to failure.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Sidelying 90/90 Thoracic Rotation; 5 reps/side
Shinbox Heel Touch; 5/side
Passive Hang; 30 sec

Thursday February 26, 2026

Week 3 Day 4 - Persist PUMP LIFT 3x

A) Active Recovery Work (30 min):
Goal: Complete 30 minutes of low-intensity steady-state movement today. You can get out for a 30-minute walk, hike on some moderate terrain, or if you like to bike or swim, have at it.

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10-20 min):
Hip Internal Rotation
Hip Sleeper Stretch x 1-2 min/side
Shinbox Hip IR Stretch x 1-2 min/side
Shinbox Active Hip IR Liftoff x 10 reps/side
Half Kneeling Weight Shift x 10 reps/side
Squat Hip Rotations x 10 reps
Supine Active Hip Internal Rotation x 5-10 reps/side

Friday February 27, 2026

Week 3 Day 5 - Persist PUMP LIFT 3x

A) Daily Focus Notes: Tempo Progression
Every other week, you'll see a change in tempo to the squats. Changing the speed helps you improve your control and movement quality. Continuing to improve our movement quality is just as important as increasing weight or reps.
Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance or Finisher.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
3 Sets
Curtsy Step Down; 6 reps/side
Single Leg Hip Thrust; 10 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity 1 (15 min):
Back Squat
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 minutes
Warm-Up Set - 5 reps @ 22X1 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 4 reps @ 33X1 - Easy
Working Set 1 - 3 @ 33X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 3 @ 33X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 3 @ 33X1 - RPE 9
Loading Note:
Prioritize a quality pause and bottom position during all sets today. For this tempo, you'll take 3 seconds to get down into the bottom position, hold tight for 3 seconds at the bottom, explode up (X), then pause for 1 second at the top. The reps have decreased, but the time under tension (tempo) has increased. RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (12 min):
Pendlay Row
3 Working Sets; rest 2 minutes
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 21X1 - Easy
Working Set 1 - 9 @ 21X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 7 @ 21X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 5 @ 21X1 - RPE 9
Loading Note:
Increase weight each set. The reps have decreased from Week 1, allowing for an increase in weight.

E) Strength Balance (12 min):
Every 60sec x 12 Sets
Odd Minutes - Weighted Strict Bar Dip x 4-6 reps @ 20X0
Even Minutes - Weighted Strict Supinated Pull Up x 4-6 reps @ 20X0
Loading Note:
The first three sets should be lighter or easier than the last three sets. Finish the last 1-2 sets at RPE 9/10.

F) Finisher (6-8 min):
2-3 sets
Bent Knee Copenhagen Raise; 8-12 reps/side
rest 15 sec
Weighted Hanging Knee Tuck; 8-12 reps
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
The goal of this finisher is to build strength in some of the smaller muscles around the pelvis and the lower abdominals. Keep quality high - you do not need to go to failure for a great stimulus in these muscles.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Slantboard Jefferson Pulse; 30 sec
Half Kneeling Hip Flexor Stretch; 30 sec/side
Seated Shoulder Extension Stretch; 30-60 sec

Saturday February 28, 2026

Week 3 Day 6 - Persist PUMP LIFT 3x

A) Active Recovery Work (40 min):
Part 1: 20 min timer (continuous movement):
200m Row or Jog
then stop and do the following:
20 sec Side Plank Right
20 sec Side Plank Left
4 Standing KB or Bodyweight Windmill Right
4 Standing KB or Bodyweight Windmill Left
*return to Row or Jog and repeat
then
Part 2: 20 min timer (continuous movement):
200m Row or Jog
then stop and do the following:
10 Underswitch to Crab Reach
15m Quadruped Crawl
20sec Bent Hollow Hold
*return to Row or Jog and repeat

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):
Squat Mobility
1. Shinbox Switch x 10 reps/side
2. Shinbox Thoracic Rotation x 5 reps/side
3. Shinbox Rear Leg ER + Shinbox Heel Touch x 5 reps/side
4. Downdog Calf Stretch x 10 reps/side
5. Weighted Ankle Stretch x 1-2 min/side
6. Frog Stretch x 1-2 min
7. Active Hip Flexion x 5 reps/side with 5 sec hold
8. Russian Babymaker x 10 reps
9. Squat Thoracic Rotations x 5 reps/side
10. Squat Hip Rotations x 10 reps/side

Sunday March 1, 2026

Week 3 Day 7 - Persist PUMP LIFT 3x

The 3/60/10 Formula

If you're training 5 days per week and thriving, keep at it. We made the 5 day tracks in Persist for people who love to be in the gym.

If that's not you, guess what - it's not me right now either.

The 3/60/10 Formula is a general guideline that works great for most people for exactly how much movement, and what kind, you need to look good and move well. I've been following it for months and it works a treat.

3 days in the gym per week (Persist PUMP LIFT or PUMP CONDITION was made for this)

60 minutes of cardio total per week (The conditioning workouts in Persist, the Active Recovery days, the 30/30 or Aerobic 40 cardio workouts you can find in the Additional Resources section of the app, or any cardio you like - all at once or broken up throughout the week.)

10k steps per day (Work up to it gradually if you're not there already.)

With this formula I recover well and hit the gym HARD. I stay active every day. And you can too.

If you've been burning the candle at both ends and considering dropping down a training day or two, you have my full permission to try it. Message us any time if you need some support.

With love,
Marcus

Pump Condition 5x

Monday February 23, 2026

Week 3 Day 1 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 5x

A) Daily Focus Notes: Conditioning to Overload Speed
The 6min AMRAP (As Many Rounds/Reps As Possible) today is broken up by a short rest. It creates an opportunity for you to speed up that you wouldn't necessarily have by going for 12 minutes straight. Rest is a tool you can use to increase your endurance, when used strategically. This is exactly why so many endurance athletes use interval training.
Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance or Conditioning

B) Warm Up (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
+

3 Sets
15 sec Cardio Sprint
Single Leg Hand Support DB RDL; 6-8 reps/side
Body Row; 12-15 reps

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Sumo Deadlift
6 Working Sets; rest 60-75 sec between sets
Warm-Up Set - 6 reps @ 21X1 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 4 reps @ 21X1 - Moderate
Warm-Up Set - 3 reps @ 21X1 - Moderate
Warm-Up Set - 3 reps @ 21X1 - Harder
Working Set 1-6: 3 reps @ 21X1 - RPE 6-8
Loading Note:
Another classic strength training rep scheme. This 6x3 will be performed around 80% of your 1RM, about 5% higher than week 1 weights. It is important to stick close to this percentage as the rest is shorter and the goal of this session is to keep quality and speed high throughout all 18 reps. The goal is not to build to a 3 rep max. Select a weight that is about an RPE 6-7 on the first working set, and then keep this weight the same for all 6 sets. As sets go on, the fatigue accumulated will increase the difficulty and thus RPE (Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure).

D) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
GHD Hip Extension or 45 Degree Hypers; 15 reps @30X0
rest 30-60 sec
Supinated Strict Pull Up; 3.2.1
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1
Loading Note:
Perform 1 warmup set of each movement to determine starting weight. Aim for RPE 7 on the first working set, and then increase weight each set, building up to RPE 9-10 on your last set.
Cluster Set - The "3.2.1" means do 3 reps, rest 10-15 sec, then 2 reps, rest 10-15 sec, then 1 rep. Use a similar weight or assistance as you would for a 5 rep max Pull Up.

E) Pull and Core Conditioning (12-15 min):
6min AMRAP (As Many Rounds/Reps As Possible)
500/400m Row Buy In (male/female)
-then in the time remaining-
2-4-6-8-10....(add 2 reps each round)

Supinated Body Row
*5 Full Squat Burpee between each round.
rest 2 minutes and then repeat for a second 6-minute AMRAP
Effort Note:
Perform at a pace that you would self select for a 8-10 min AMRAP. This will make the 6 min AMRAP feel challenging, but sustainable enough to perform the second AMRAP with quality.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Lumbar Roll to Pancake Stretch; 5 reps with 5 sec stretch
Single Arm Wall Prayer Stretch x 30 sec/side
Pigeon Stretch; 30-60 sec/side

Tuesday February 24, 2026

Week 3 Day 2 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 5x

A) Daily Focus Notes: Supporting Player Shoulder Muscles
If you want a big bench, stronger pressing, and more Pull Ups, then work on improving the muscles that support your shoulders as well as your shoulders directly. The Strength Balance section today targets some of these supporting muscles with the goal of bringing more balance and capacity to the entire area.
Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance

B) Warmup (8 min):
3 Rounds
90 sec Cardio of Choice
Half Kneeling DB Windmill; 5 reps/side
Banded Face Pull; 15-20 reps

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Strict Press
4 Working Sets; rest 90 sec
Warm-Up Set - 8 reps @ 21X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 8 reps @ 21X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 8 reps @ 21X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 8 reps @ 21X1 - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - Max Unbroken reps @ 20X0 - RPE 10 (NO PAUSES - Same weight as Set 3)
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
Flat Bench DB Fly; 10-12 reps @20X0
rest 30-60 sec
DB Full Raise; 10-12 reps @20X0
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1
Loading Note:
Aim for each set to be close to failure.

E) Upper Body Grinder (15 min time cap):
5 Rounds For Time
12/10 Cal Row (male/female)
8 Wtd Hanging Knee Tuck 25/15# or 15/10#
4 Wall Walks or 8 Inchworm Push Ups
15m/side Single Arm Farmers Walk
Effort Note:
The movements require a slow and steady grind for completion. To not hit failure too early into the workout on the upper body movements.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Sidelying 90/90 Thoracic Rotation; 5 reps/side
Seated Shoulder Extension Stretch; 30 sec
Passive Hang; 30 sec

Wednesday February 25, 2026

Week 3 Day 3 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 5x

A) Daily Focus Notes: B Stance Hip Thrust
This exercise needs your attention so that you don't compensate by using the bottom supporting leg or overarching the low back. Try to avoid these faults so you can keep the tension on the glutes. Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance or Conditioning.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
3 Sets
Curtsy Step Down; 6 reps/side
Single Leg Hip Thrust; 10 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Back Squat
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 minutes
Warm-Up Set - 5 reps @ 22X1 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 4 reps @ 33X1 - Easy
Working Set 1 - 3 @ 33X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 3 @ 33X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 3 @ 33X1 - RPE 9

Loading Note:

Prioritize a quality pause and bottom position during all sets today. For your working sets, you'll take 3 seconds to get down into the bottom position, hold tight for 3 seconds at the bottom, explode up (X), then pause for 1 second at the top. The reps have decreased, but the time under tension (tempo) has increased. Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
B Stance Barbell Hip Thrust; 6 reps/side
rest 30-60 sec
Hand Support Suitcase Single Leg Calf Raise; 10-12 reps/side @20X0
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1

Loading Note:

Perform 1 warmup set for each movement to determine the starting weight. Aim for the first set to be RPE 7 and then increase weight each set.

E) Functional Pump Conditioning (12-15 min):
Every 4mins x 3 Sets
8-12 DB Power Clean 50/35# (male/female)
8-12 DB Front Squat 50/35#
400-500m Bike
Effort Note:

The goal is to find reps and weights that allow you to finish these sets in around 3mins, giving you 1min to rest before you begin again. If you are unsure about how long this will take, then I recommend starting with the lower rep range and adding more reps or weight as you go if you are finishing too quickly and easily.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Slantboard Jefferson Pulse; 30 sec

Half Kneeling Hip Flexor Stretch; 30 sec/side
Shinbox Heel Touch; 5 reps/side

Thursday February 26, 2026

Week 3 Day 4 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 5x

A) Active Recovery Work (40 min):
Part 1: 20 min timer (continuous movement):
200m Row or Jog
then stop and do the following:
20 sec Side Plank Right
20 sec Side Plank Left
4 Standing KB or Bodyweight Windmill Right
4 Standing KB or Bodyweight Windmill Left
*return to Row or Jog and repeat
then
Part 2: 20 min timer (continuous movement):
200m Row or Jog
then stop and do the following:
10 Underswitch to Crab Reach
15m Quadruped Crawl
20sec Bent Hollow Hold
*return to Row or Jog and repeat

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):
Thoracic Mobility
Segmented Cat Cow x 5 reps
Childs Pose Lat Stretch x 30 sec/side
Sidelying Thoracic Rotation x 5 reps/side with 5 sec hold
T Spine Can Opener x 1-2 min
Banded Shoulder Extension x 1 min
Active Banded Shoulder Extension x 5 reps
Yoga Push Up x 5 reps

Friday February 27, 2026

Week 3 Day 5 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 5x

A) Daily Focus Notes: Bench for Triceps

The Bench Press is often viewed as a chest exercise, but happens to be one of the best tricep exercises you can do. The Triceps are forced to go through a large range of motion with a lot of weight, even while being supported by the pecs. The Close-Grip Bench Press is a subtle variation that forces even a little more tricep and less chest. Place your hands straight out from your shoulders, as if you were imitating a zombie.
Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
3 Sets
15 sec Cardio Sprint
Pushup with Shoulder Tap; 4-5 reps/side
Supinated Pull Up Isometric; 10 sec

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
1 1/4 Close-Grip Bench Press
4 Working Sets; rest 2 minutes
Warm-Up Set - 5 reps @ 20X1 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 5 reps @ 20X1 - Easy
Working Set 1 - 5 @ 20X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 5 @ 20X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 5 @ 20X1 - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - Remove the 1/4 Rep and perform Max reps of Close-Grip Bench Press @ Set 1 weight.
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - Scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (10 min):
3 sets
Barbell Skullcrusher; 10 reps @20X0
rest 30 sec
Reverse Barbell Curl; 10 reps @20X0
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1
Loading Note:
Aim for each set to be close to failure.

E) Push Pull Sprint (12-15 min):
4 Sets @ high effort
12 Bulgarian Ring Rows @ 20X0

Row 10/8 Cal Sprint (male/female)
40m Mixed Rack Overhead Carry TOUGH (switch arms halfway)
rest walk 90-120sec between sets
Effort Note:
There are 3 phases to this conditioning format. Start with a high-quality Pull or Push for strength and hypertrophy. Then challenge your sprint capacity on the cardio. Finally, while breathing heavily, start your carry and move with great control.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Forward Shoulder Wall Circles; 10 reps/side
Banded Shoulder Flexion Stretch; 30 sec
Banded Shoulder Extension Stretch; 30 sec

Saturday February 28, 2026

Week 3 Day 6 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 5x

A) Daily Focus Notes: High Volume Bodyweight Movements
The high volume of bodyweight movements in today's conditioning section will get your blood flowing through your entire body. This is a unique cardiovascular stimulus compared with using heavy weights. Bodyweight movements are a fantastic tool to keep cardio workouts fun and interesting, without burning your body out.
Short on Time? Perform 2 sets of Strength Intensity 1.

B) Warmup (8 min):
3 Rounds
90 sec Cardio of Choice
Forward Lunge; 6/side
Goblet Good Morning; 10 reps

C) Strength Intensity Giant Set (18 min):
4 sets
Goblet Cyclist Squat; 6-8 reps @22X1 Tempo
rest 30 sec
Single Leg Hand Support DB RDL; 5-7 reps/side @30X0
rest 30 sec
Single Arm DB Suitcase Drop Lunge; 10 reps/side
rest 2 min and back to 1.
Loading Note:

For this lower body giant set, the goal is to use one DB for each set. Perform 1 warmup set to determine starting weight. Aim for the first set to be around RPE 7. Increase weight each set with the goal of an increasing RPE. For the Drop Lunge, perform all reps on one side before switching to the other side. RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - Scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Lower Body Conditioning (15-20 min):
2-3 Rounds For Time
45/36 Cal Row (male/female)
30 Squat Jump
25 V Ups OR Tuck Ups
20 Alternating Bodyweight Russian Step Up 24/20"
*20 min time cap.
Effort Note:
Bodyweight movements require lower muscle contraction, allowing you to continue to move under higher perception of fatigue. Try to not stop moving, even if you have to reduce the pace.

E) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Half Split Hip Hinge; 6-8 reps/side
Weighted Ankle Stretch; 30 sec/side
Bottom of Squat Hold; 30 sec

Sunday March 1, 2026

Week 3 Day 7 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 5x

The 3/60/10 Formula

If you're training 5 days per week and thriving, keep at it. We made the 5 day tracks in Persist for people who love to be in the gym.

If that's not you, guess what - it's not me right now either.

The 3/60/10 Formula is a general guideline that works great for most people for exactly how much movement, and what kind, you need to look good and move well. I've been following it for months and it works a treat.

3 days in the gym per week (Persist PUMP LIFT or PUMP CONDITION was made for this)

60 minutes of cardio total per week (The conditioning workouts in Persist, the Active Recovery days, the 30/30 or Aerobic 40 cardio workouts you can find in the Additional Resources section of the app, or any cardio you like - all at once or broken up throughout the week.)

10k steps per day (Work up to it gradually if you're not there already.)

With this formula I recover well and hit the gym HARD. I stay active every day. And you can too.

If you've been burning the candle at both ends and considering dropping down a training day or two, you have my full permission to try it. Message us any time if you need some support.

With love,
Marcus

Pump Condition 4x

Monday February 23, 2026

Week 3 Day 1 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 4x

A) Daily Focus Notes: Supporting Player Shoulder Muscles
If you want a big bench, stronger pressing, and more Pull Ups, then work on improving the muscles that support your shoulders as well as your shoulders directly. The Strength Balance section today targets some of these supporting muscles with the goal of bringing more balance and capacity to the entire area.
Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance

B) Warmup (8 min):
3 Rounds
90 sec Cardio of Choice
Half Kneeling DB Windmill; 5 reps/side
Banded Face Pull; 15-20 reps

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Strict Press
4 Working Sets; rest 90 sec
Warm-Up Set - 8 reps @ 21X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 8 reps @ 21X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 8 reps @ 21X1 - RPE 8

Working Set 3 - 8 reps @ 21X1 - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - Max Unbroken reps @ 20X0 - RPE 10 (NO PAUSES - Same weight as Set 3)
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (15 min):
3 sets
Pronated Strict Pull Up; 6-8 reps @30X1
rest 30sec
Flat Bench DB Fly; 10-12 reps @20X0
rest 30sec
DB Full Raise; 10-12 reps @20X0
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1
Loading Note:
Aim for each set to be close to failure.

E) Upper Body Grinder (15 min time cap):
5 Rounds For Time
12/10 Cal Row (male/female)
8 Wtd Hanging Knee Tuck 25/15# or 15/10#
4 Wall Walks or 8 Inchworm Push Ups
15m/side Single Arm Farmers Walk
Effort Note:
The movements require a slow and steady grind for completion. Try not to hit failure too early into the workout on the upper body movements.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1) Sidelying 90/90 Thoracic Rotation; 5 reps/side
2) Seated Shoulder Extension Stretch; 30 sec
3) Passive Hang; 30 sec

Tuesday February 24, 2026

Week 3 Day 2 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 4x

A) Daily Focus Notes: DB Positioning
Every time you change your dumbbell position for a squat or hinge, you impact the muscles that support the pelvis. Notice in the Strength Balance section how these small position changes feel in your hips as you naturally brace to support each movement.
Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance or Conditioning

B) Warm Up (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
3 Sets
15 sec Cardio Sprint
Single Leg Hand Support DB RDL; 6-8 reps/side
Body Row; 12-15 reps

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Sumo Deadlift
6 Working Sets; rest 60-75 sec between sets
Warm-Up Set - 6 reps @ 21X1 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 4 reps @ 21X1 - Moderate
Warm-Up Set - 3 reps @ 21X1 - Moderate
Warm-Up Set - 3 reps @ 21X1 - Harder
Working Set 1-6: 3 reps @ 21X1 - RPE 6-8
Loading Note:
Another classic strength training rep scheme. This 6x3 will be performed around 80% of your 1RM, about 5% higher than week 1 weights. It is important to stick close to this percentage as the rest is shorter and the goal of this session is to keep quality and speed high throughout all 18 reps. The goal is not to build to a 3 rep max. Select a weight that is about an RPE 6-7 on the first working set, and then keep this weight the same for all 6 sets. As sets go on, the fatigue accumulated will increase the difficulty and thus RPE (Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure).

D) Strength Balance (15 min):
3 sets
Goblet Cyclist Squat; 8 reps @33X1
rest 30 sec
Single Arm DB Suitcase Drop Lunge; 10 reps/side
rest 2 min and back to 1.
Loading Note:
For this lower body superset, the goal is to use one DB for each set. Perform 1 warmup set to determine starting weight. Aim for the first set to be around RPE 7. Increase weight each set with the goal of an increasing RPE. For the Drop Lunge, perform all reps on one side before switching to the other side.

E) Lower Body Conditioning (15-20 min):

2-3 Rounds For Time
45/36 Cal Row (male/female)
30 Squat Jump
25 V Ups OR Tuck Ups
20 Alternating Bodyweight Russian Step Up 24/20"
*20 min time cap.
Effort Note:
Bodyweight movements require lower muscle contraction, allowing you to continue to move under higher perception of fatigue. Try to not stop moving, even if you have to reduce the pace.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Slantboard Jefferson Pulse; 30 sec
Half Kneeling Hip Flexor Stretch; 30 sec/side
Shinbox Heel Touch; 5 reps/side

Wednesday February 25, 2026

Week 3 Day 3 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 4x

A) Active Recovery Work (30 min): Goal: Complete 30 minutes of low-intensity steady-state movement today. You can get out for a 30-minute walk, hike on some moderate terrain, or if you like to bike or swim, have at it.

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):
Thoracic Mobility
Segmented Cat Cow x 5 reps
Childs Pose Lat Stretch x 30 sec/side
Sidelying Thoracic Rotation x 5 reps/side with 5 sec hold
T Spine Can Opener x 1-2 min
Banded Shoulder Extension x 1 min
Active Banded Shoulder Extension x 5 reps
Yoga Pushup x 5 reps

Thursday February 26, 2026

Week 3 Day 4 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 4x

A) Daily Focus Notes: Bench for Triceps

The Bench Press is often viewed as a chest exercise, but happens to be one of the best tricep exercises you can do. The Triceps are forced to go through a large range of motion with a lot of weight, even while being supported by the pecs. The Close-Grip Bench Press is a subtle variation that forces even a little more tricep and less chest. Place your hands straight out from your shoulders, as if you were imitating a zombie.
Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
3 Sets
15 sec Cardio Sprint
Pushup with Shoulder Tap; 4-5 reps/side
Supinated Pull Up Isometric; 10 sec

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
1 1/4 Close-Grip Bench Press
4 Working Sets; rest 2 minutes
Warm-Up Set - 5 reps @ 20X1 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 5 reps @ 20X1 - Easy
Working Set 1 - 5 @ 20X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 5 @ 20X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 5 @ 20X1 - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - Remove the 1/4 Rep and perform Max reps of Close-Grip Bench Press @ Set 1 weight.
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - Scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (10 min):
3 sets
Barbell Skullcrusher; 10 reps @20X0
rest 30 sec
Reverse Barbell Curl; 10 reps @20X0
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1
Loading Note:
Aim for each set to be close to failure.

E) Push Pull Sprint (12-15 min):
4 Sets @ high effort
12 Bulgarian Ring Rows @ 20X0

Row 10/8 Cal Sprint (male/female)
40m Mixed Rack Overhead Carry TOUGH (switch arms halfway)
rest walk 90-120sec between sets
Effort Note:
There are 3 phases to this conditioning format. Start with a high-quality Pull or Push for strength and hypertrophy. Then challenge your sprint capacity on the cardio. Finally, while breathing heavily, start your carry and move with great control.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Forward Shoulder Wall Circles; 10 reps/side
Banded Shoulder Flexion Stretch; 30 sec
Banded Shoulder Extension Stretch; 30 sec

Friday February 27, 2026

Week 3 Day 5 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 4x

A) Daily Focus Notes: B Stance Hip Thrust
This exercise needs your attention so that you don't compensate by using the bottom supporting leg or overarching the low back. Try to avoid these faults so you can keep the tension on the glutes. Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance or Conditioning.

B) Warmup (8 min):
3 Rounds
90 sec Cardio of Choice
Forward Lunge; 6/side
Goblet Good Morning; 10 reps

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Back Squat
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 minutes
Warm-Up Set - 5 reps @ 22X1 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 4 reps @ 33X1 - Easy
Working Set 1 - 3 @ 33X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 3 @ 33X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 3 @ 33X1 - RPE 9
Loading Note:
Prioritize a quality pause and bottom position during all sets today. For your working sets, you'll take 3 seconds to get down into the bottom position, hold tight for 3 seconds at the bottom,

explode up (X), then pause for 1 second at the top. The reps have decreased, but the time under tension (tempo) has increased. Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
B Stance Barbell Hip Thrust; 6 reps/side
rest 30-60 sec
Hand Support Suitcase Single Leg Calf Raise; 10-12 reps/side @20X0
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1
Loading Note:
Perform 1 warmup set for each movement to determine the starting weight. Aim for the first set to be RPE 7 and then increase weight each set.

E) Functional Pump Conditioning (12-15 min):
Every 4mins x 3 Sets
8-12 DB Power Clean 50/35# (male/female)
8-12 DB Front Squat 50/35#
400-500m Bike
Effort Note:
The goal is to find reps and weights that allow you to finish these sets in around 3mins, giving you 1min to rest before you begin again. If you are unsure about how long this will take, then I recommend starting with the lower rep range and adding more reps or weight as you go if you are finishing too quickly and easily.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Half Split Hip Hinge; 6-8 reps/side
Weighted Ankle Stretch; 30 sec/side
Bottom of Squat Hold; 30 sec

Saturday February 28, 2026

Week 3 Day 6 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 4x

A) Active Recovery Work (40 min):
Part 1: 20 min timer (continuous movement):
200m Row or Jog
then stop and do the following:
20 sec Side Plank Right
20 sec Side Plank Left

4 Standing KB or Bodyweight Windmill Right
4 Standing KB or Bodyweight Windmill Left
*return to Row or Jog and repeat
then
Part 2: 20 min timer (continuous movement):
200m Row or Jog
then stop and do the following:
10 Underswitch to Crab Reach
15m Quadruped Crawl
20sec Bent Hollow Hold
*return to Row or Jog and repeat

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10-20 min):
Hip Internal Rotation
Hip Sleeper Stretch x 1-2 min/side
Shinbox Hip IR Stretch x 1-2 min/side
Shinbox Active Hip IR Liftoff x 10 reps/side
Half Kneeling Weight Shift x 10 reps/side
Squat Hip Rotations x 10 reps
Supine Active Hip Internal Rotation x 5-10 reps/side

Sunday March 1, 2026

Week 3 Day 7 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 4x

The 3/60/10 Formula

If you're training 5 days per week and thriving, keep at it. We made the 5 day tracks in Persist for people who love to be in the gym.

If that's not you, guess what - it's not me right now either.

The 3/60/10 Formula is a general guideline that works great for most people for exactly how much movement, and what kind, you need to look good and move well. I've been following it for months and it works a treat.

3 days in the gym per week (Persist PUMP LIFT or PUMP CONDITION was made for this)

60 minutes of cardio total per week (The conditioning workouts in Persist, the Active Recovery days, the 30/30 or Aerobic 40 cardio workouts you can find in the Additional Resources section of the app, or any cardio you like - all at once or broken up throughout the week.)

10k steps per day (Work up to it gradually if you're not there already.)

With this formula I recover well and hit the gym HARD. I stay active every day. And you can too.

If you've been burning the candle at both ends and considering dropping down a training day or two, you have my full permission to try it. Message us any time if you need some support.

With love,
Marcus

Pump Condition 3x

Monday February 23, 2026

Week 3 Day 1 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 3x

A) Daily Focus Notes: Vertical Pressing
Throughout this training cycle, you'll see three different vertical pressing movements: the Landmine Press, Filly Press, and Strict Press. Each one explores different parts of the shoulder - keeping this movement pattern fresh, while avoiding overuse.
Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance or Conditioning

B) Warm Up (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
3 Sets
15 sec Cardio Sprint
Single Leg Hand Support DB RDL; 6-8 reps/side
Body Row; 12-15 reps

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Sumo Deadlift
6 Working Sets; rest 60-75 sec between sets
Warm-Up Set - 6 reps @ 21X1 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 4 reps @ 21X1 - Moderate

Warm-Up Set - 3 reps @ 21X1 - Moderate
Warm-Up Set - 3 reps @ 21X1 - Harder
Working Set 1-6: 3 reps @ 21X1 - RPE 6-8

Loading Note:

Another classic strength training rep scheme. This 6x3 will be performed around 80% of your 1RM, about 5% higher than week 1 weights. It is important to stick close to this percentage as the rest is shorter and the goal of this session is to keep quality and speed high throughout all 18 reps. The goal is not to build to a 3 rep max. Select a weight that is about an RPE 6-7 on the first working set, and then keep this weight the same for all 6 sets. As sets go on, the fatigue accumulated will increase the difficulty and thus RPE (Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure).

D) Strength Balance (15 min):
3 sets
Pronated Strict Pull Up; 6-8 reps @30X1
rest 30sec
DB Strict Press; 10-12 reps @20X0
rest 30sec
DB Full Raise; 10-12 reps @20X0
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1

Loading Note:

Aim for each set to be close to failure.

E) Lower Body Conditioning (15-20 min):
2-3 Rounds For Time
45/36 Cal Row (male/female)
30 Squat Jump
25 V Ups OR Tuck Ups
20 Alternating Bodyweight Russian Step Up 24/20"
*20 min time cap.
Effort Note:
Bodyweight movements require lower muscle contraction, allowing you to continue to move under higher perception of fatigue. Try to not stop moving, even if you have to reduce the pace.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Lumbar Roll to Pancake Stretch; 5 reps with 5 sec stretch
Single Arm Wall Prayer Stretch x 30 sec/side
Pigeon Stretch; 30-60 sec/side

Tuesday February 24, 2026

Week 3 Day 2 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 3x

A) Active Recovery Work (30 min): Goal: Complete 30 minutes of low-intensity steady-state movement today. You can get out for a 30-minute walk, hike on some moderate terrain, or if you like to bike or swim, have at it.

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):
Thoracic Mobility
Segmented Cat Cow x 5 reps
Childs Pose Lat Stretch x 30 sec/side
Sidelying Thoracic Rotation x 5 reps/side with 5 sec hold
T Spine Can Opener x 1-2 min
Banded Shoulder Extension x 1 min
Active Banded Shoulder Extension x 5 reps
Yoga Pushup x 5 reps

Wednesday February 25, 2026

Week 3 Day 3 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 3x

A) Daily Focus Notes: DB Positioning
Every time you change your dumbbell position for a squat or hinge, you impact the muscles that support the pelvis. Notice in the Strength Balance section how these small position changes feel in your hips as you naturally brace to support each movement.
Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance or Conditioning

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
3 Sets
15 sec Cardio Sprint
Push Up With Shoulder Tap; 4-5 reps/side
Supinated Pull Up Isometric; 10 sec

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
1 1/4 Close-Grip Bench Press
4 Working Sets; rest 2 minutes
Warm-Up Set - 5 reps @ 20X1 Tempo - Easy

Warm-Up Set - 5 reps @ 20X1 - Easy
Working Set 1 - 5 @ 20X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 5 @ 20X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 5 @ 20X1 - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - Remove the 1/4 Rep and perform Max reps of Close-Grip Bench Press @ Set 1 weight.
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - Scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (15 min):
3 sets
Goblet Cyclist Squat; 8 reps @33X1
rest 30 sec
Single Arm DB Suitcase Drop Lunge; 10 reps/side
rest 2 min and back to 1.
Loading Note:
For this lower body superset, the goal is to use one DB for each set. Perform 1 warmup set to determine starting weight. Aim for the first set to be around RPE 7. Increase weight each set with the goal of an increasing RPE. For the Drop Lunge, perform all reps on one side before switching to the other side.

E) Push Pull Sprint (12-15 min):
4 Sets @ high effort
12 Bulgarian Ring Rows @ 20X0
Row 10/8 Cal Sprint (male/female)
40m Mixed Rack Overhead Carry TOUGH (switch arms halfway)
rest walk 90-120sec between sets
Effort Note:
There are 3 phases to this conditioning format. Start with a high-quality Pull or Push for strength and hypertrophy. Then challenge your sprint capacity on the cardio. Finally, while breathing heavily, start your carry and move with great control.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Sidelying 90/90 Thoracic Rotation; 5 reps/side
Shinbox Heel Touch; 5/side
Passive Hang; 30 sec

Thursday February 26, 2026

Week 3 Day 4 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 3x

A) Active Recovery Work (30 min): Goal: Complete 30 minutes of low-intensity steady-state movement today. You can get out for a 30-minute walk, hike on some moderate terrain, or if you like to bike or swim, have at it.

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10-20 min):
Hip Internal Rotation
Hip Sleeper Stretch x 1-2 min/side
2.Shinbox Hip IR Stretch x 1-2 min/side
Shinbox Active Hip IR Liftoff x 10 reps/side
Half Kneeling Weight Shift x 10 reps/side
Squat Hip Rotations x 10 reps
Supine Active Hip Internal Rotation x 5-10 reps/side

Friday February 27, 2026

Week 3 Day 5 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 3x

A) Daily Focus Notes: Reverse Barbell Curl
Building your biceps involves several muscles, not just one. The change in hand position of the Reverse Barbell Curl helps develop this muscle group in a slightly different way.
Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance or Conditioning.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
3 Sets
Curtsy Step Down; 6 reps/side
Single Leg Hip Thrust; 10 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Back Squat
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 minutes
Warm-Up Set - 5 reps @ 22X1 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 4 reps @ 33X1 - Easy
Working Set 1 - 3 @ 33X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 3 @ 33X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 3 @ 33X1 - RPE 9
Loading Note:

Prioritize a quality pause and bottom position during all sets today. For your working sets, you'll take 3 seconds to get down into the bottom position, hold tight for 3 seconds at the bottom, explode up (X), then pause for 1 second at the top. The reps have decreased, but the time under tension (tempo) has increased. Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (10 min):
3 sets
Barbell Skullcrusher; 10 reps @20X0
rest 30 sec
Reverse Barbell Curl; 10 reps @20X0
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1
Loading Note:
Aim for each set to be close to failure.

E) Functional Pump Conditioning (12-15 min):
Every 4mins x 3 Sets
8-12 DB Power Clean 50/35# (male/female)
8-12 DB Push Press
400-500m Bike
Effort Note:
The goal is to find reps and weights that allow you to finish these sets in around 3mins, giving you 1min to rest before you begin again. If you are unsure about how long this will take, then I recommend starting with the lower rep range and adding more reps or weight as you go if you are finishing too quickly and easily.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Slantboard Jefferson Pulse; 30 sec
Half Kneeling Hip Flexor Stretch; 30 sec/side
Seated Shoulder Extension Stretch; 30-60 sec

Saturday February 28, 2026

Week 3 Day 6 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 3x

A) Active Recovery Work (40 min):
40 min total work
Part 1: 20 min timer (continuous movement):
200m Row or Jog
then stop and do the following:

20 sec Side Plank Right
20 sec Side Plank Left
4 Standing KB or Bodyweight Windmill Right
4 Standing KB or Bodyweight Windmill Left
*return to Row or Jog and repeat
then
Part 2: 20 min timer (continuous movement):
200m Row or Jog
then stop and do the following:
10 Underswitch to Crab Reach
15m Quadruped Crawl
20sec Bent Hollow Hold
*return to Row or Jog and repeat

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):
Squat Mobility
1.Shinbox Switch x 10 reps/side
2. Shinbox Thoracic Rotation x 5 reps/side
3. Shinbox Rear Leg ER + Shinbox Heel Touch x 5 reps/side
4. Downdog Calf Stretch x 10 reps/side
5. Weighted Ankle Stretch x 1-2 min/side
6. Frog Stretch x 1-2 min
7. Active Hip Flexion x 5 reps/side with 5 sec hold
8. Russian Babymaker x 10 reps
9. Squat Thoracic Rotations x 5 reps/side
10. Squat Hip Rotations x 10 reps/side

Sunday March 1, 2026

Week 3 Day 7 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 3x

The 3/60/10 Formula

If you're training 5 days per week and thriving, keep at it. We made the 5 day tracks in Persist for people who love to be in the gym.

If that's not you, guess what - it's not me right now either.

The 3/60/10 Formula is a general guideline that works great for most people for exactly how much movement, and what kind, you need to look good and move well. I've been following it for months and it works a treat.

3 days in the gym per week (Persist PUMP LIFT or PUMP CONDITION was made for this)

60 minutes of cardio total per week (The conditioning workouts in Persist, the Active Recovery days, the 30/30 or Aerobic 40 cardio workouts you can find in the Additional Resources section of the app, or any cardio you like - all at once or broken up throughout the week.)

10k steps per day (Work up to it gradually if you're not there already.)

With this formula I recover well and hit the gym HARD. I stay active every day. And you can too.

If you've been burning the candle at both ends and considering dropping down a training day or two, you have my full permission to try it. Message us any time if you need some support.

With love,
Marcus

Perform

Monday February 23, 2026

Week 3 Day 1 - Persist PERFORM

A) Daily Focus Notes: Conditioning to Overload Speed
The 6min AMRAP (As Many Rounds/Reps As Possible) today is broken up by a short rest. It creates an opportunity for you to speed up that you wouldn't necessarily have by going for 12 minutes straight. Rest is a tool you can use to increase your endurance, when used strategically. This is exactly why so many endurance athletes use interval training.
Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance or Conditioning

B) Warm Up (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
3 Sets
15 sec Cardio Sprint

Single Leg Hand Support DB RDL; 6-8 reps/side
Body Row; 12-15 reps

C) HOT START (10-12 minutes):
4 Rounds Increasing Effort:
15/12 Calorie Row (male/female)
5 KB Rotational Snatch Right 53/35# or 35/26#
5 KB Overhead Reverse Lunge Right 53/35# or 35/26#
5 KB Rotational Snatch Left 53/35# or 35/26#
5 KB Overhead Reverse Lunge Left 53/35# or 35/26#
10 Goblet Tall Kneel to Stand
rest 45 sec between rounds
Effort Note:
Round 1 - Moderate
Round 2 - Hard
Round 3-4 - Very Tough Pace

D) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Sumo Deadlift
6 Working Sets; rest 60-75 sec between sets
Warm-Up Set - 6 reps @ 21X1 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 4 reps @ 21X1 - Moderate
Warm-Up Set - 3 reps @ 21X1 - Moderate
Warm-Up Set - 3 reps @ 21X1 - Harder
Working Set 1-6: 3 reps @ 21X1 - RPE 6-8
Loading Note:
Another classic strength training rep scheme. This 6x3 will be performed around 80% of your 1RM, about 5% higher than week 1 weights. It is important to stick close to this percentage as the rest is shorter and the goal of this session is to keep quality and speed high throughout all 18 reps. The goal is not to build to a 3 rep max. Select a weight that is about an RPE 6-7 on the first working set, and then keep this weight the same for all 6 sets. As sets go on, the fatigue accumulated will increase the difficulty and thus RPE (Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure).

E) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
GHD Hip Extension or 45 Degree Hypers; 15 reps @30X0
rest 30-60 sec
Supinated Strict Pull Up; 3.2.1

rest 60-90 sec and back to 1

Loading Note:

Perform 1 warmup set of each movement to determine starting weight. Aim for RPE 7 on the first working set, and then increase weight each set, building up to RPE 9-10 on your last set.
Cluster Set - The "3.2.1" means do 3 reps, rest 10-15 sec, then 2 reps, rest 10-15 sec, then 1 rep. Use a similar weight or assistance as you would for a 5 rep max pull up.

F) Pull Conditioning (12-15 min):
6min AMRAP (As Many Rounds/Reps As Possible)
500/400m Row Buy In (male/female)
-then in the time remaining-
2-4-6-8-10....(add 2 reps each round)
Power Clean (115/85#)
*5 Full Squat Burpee between each round.
rest 2 minutes and then repeat for a second 6-minute AMRAP
Effort Note:
Perform at a pace that you would self select for a 8-10 min AMRAP. This will make the 6 min AMRAP feel challenging, but sustainable enough to perform the second AMRAP with quality.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Lumbar Roll to Pancake Stretch; 5 reps with 5 sec stretch
Single Arm Wall Prayer Stretch x 30 sec/side
Pigeon Stretch; 30-60 sec/side

Tuesday February 24, 2026

Week 3 Day 2 - Persist PERFORM

A) Daily Focus Notes: Supporting Player Shoulder Muscles
If you want a big bench, stronger pressing, and more Pull Ups, then work on improving the muscles that support your shoulders as well as your shoulders directly. The Strength Balance section today targets some of these supporting muscles with the goal of bringing more balance and capacity to the entire area.
Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance

B) Warmup (8 min):
3 Rounds
90 sec Cardio of Choice
Half Kneeling DB Windmill; 5 reps/side

Banded Face Pull; 15-20 reps

C) Dip + Core + Shoulder Prefatigue (12 min):
3 Working Sets
Strict Bar or Ring Dip; 4-6 reps @32X1
directly into
Alternating Oblique Raise in Dip Support; 4-6 reps/side
rest 15sec
Single Arm DB Cuban Press; 10 reps/side
rest 90sec between sets
Effort Note:
Increase intensity each set. Start on the lower end of the reps (with less weight on the DB) and then increase weight and reps.

D) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Strict Press
4 Working Sets; rest 90 sec
Warm-Up Set - 8 reps @ 21X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 8 reps @ 21X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 8 reps @ 21X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 8 reps @ 21X1 - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - Max Unbroken reps @ 20X0 - RPE 10 (NO PAUSES - Same weight as Set 3)
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

E) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
Flat Bench DB Fly; 10-12 reps @20X0
rest 30-60 sec
DB Full Raise; 10-12 reps @20X0
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1
Loading Note:
Aim for each set to be close to failure.

F) Upper Body Conditioning (15 min):
3:30 AMRAP (As Many Row Cals As Possible) x 3 Sets:
Buy In - 2 Rounds:
15 Single Arm DB Bench Press Right Arm
30m Single Arm Overhead Carry Right Arm
15 Single Arm DB Bench Press Left Arm

30m Single Arm Overhead Carry Left Arm
*Then in remaining time:
Row as many Calories as Possible
rest 90 sec between sets
Effort Note:
Use lighter weights if you need more time to row. Try to leave yourself about 60-90 seconds of rowing each set.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Sidelying 90/90 Thoracic Rotation; 5 reps/side
Seated Shoulder Extension Stretch; 30 sec
Passive Hang; 30 sec

Wednesday February 25, 2026

Week 3 Day 3 - Persist PERFORM

A) Daily Focus Notes: B Stance Hip Thrust
This exercise needs your attention so that you don't compensate by using the bottom supporting leg or overarching the low back. Try to avoid these faults so you can keep the tension on the glutes. Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance or Conditioning.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
3 Sets
Curtsy Step Down; 6 reps/side
Single Leg Hip Thrust; 10 reps/side

C) Speed Strength - Snatch (15 min):
Barbell Warm-up:
1-2 Sets (with Empty Barbell)
10 Snatch Grip Romanian Deadlift
10 BTN Snatch Press or BTN Snatch Push Press
10 Overhead Squat
10 sec Squatting Quad Snatch Grip Hold
10 sec Snatch Grip Overhead Hold
10 sec Overhead Squat Hold
+

Every 2:00 x 5 sets
2 Hang Power Snatch
rest until the next 2:00
Sets 1-2: Easy
Set 3-4: Moderate
Set 5: Challenging

D) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Back Squat
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 minutes
Warm-Up Set - 5 reps @ 22X1 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 4 reps @ 33X1 - Easy
Working Set 1 - 3 @ 33X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 3 @ 33X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 3 @ 33X1 - RPE 9
Loading Note:
Prioritize a quality pause and bottom position during all sets today. For your working sets, you'll take 3 seconds to get down into the bottom position, hold tight for 3 seconds at the bottom, explode up (X), then pause for 1 second at the top. The reps have decreased, but the time under tension (tempo) has increased. Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

E) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
B Stance Barbell Hip Thrust; 6 reps/side
rest 30-60 sec
Hand Support Suitcase Single Leg Calf Raise; 10-12 reps/side @20X0
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1
Loading Note:
Perform 1 warmup set for each movement to determine the starting weight. Aim for the first set to be RPE 7 and then increase weight each set.

F) Lower Body Conditioning (15-20 min):
2-3 Rounds For Time
45/36 Cal Row (male/female)
30 DB Jump Lunge (35/25#)
25 V Ups OR Tuck Ups
10 DB Suitcase Box Step Up (35/25#) (5/side)
*20 min time cap.
Effort Note:

High rep numbers are challenging, but the movements are light enough to allow for constant movement. Try not to come to a complete stop throughout this workout.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Slantboard Jefferson Pulse; 30 sec
Half Kneeling Hip Flexor Stretch; 30 sec/side
Shinbox Heel Touch; 5 reps/side

Thursday February 26, 2026

Week 3 Day 4 - Persist PERFORM

A) Active Recovery Work (40 min):
Part 1: 20 min timer (continuous movement):
200m Row or Jog
then stop and do the following:
20 sec Side Plank Right
20 sec Side Plank Left
4 Standing KB or Bodyweight Windmill Right
4 Standing KB or Bodyweight Windmill Left
*return to Row or Jog and repeat
then
Part 2: 20 min timer (continuous movement):
200m Row or Jog
then stop and do the following:
10 Underswitch to Crab Reach
15m Quadruped Crawl
20sec Bent Hollow Hold
*return to Row or Jog and repeat

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):
Thoracic Mobility
Segmented Cat Cow x 5 reps
Childs Pose Lat Stretch x 30 sec/side
Sidelying Thoracic Rotation x 5 reps/side with 5 sec hold
T Spine Can Opener x 1-2 min
Banded Shoulder Extension x 1 min
Active Banded Shoulder Extension x 5 reps
Yoga Pushup x 5 reps

Friday February 27, 2026

Week 3 Day 5 - Persist PERFORM

A) Daily Focus Notes: Bench for Triceps
The Bench Press is often viewed as a chest exercise, but happens to be one of the best tricep exercises you can do. The Triceps are forced to go through a large range of motion with a lot of weight, even while being supported by the pecs. The Close-Grip Bench Press is a subtle variation that forces even a little more tricep and less chest. Place your hands straight out from your shoulders, as if you were imitating a zombie.
Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
3 Sets
15 sec Cardio Sprint
Pushup with Shoulder Tap; 4-5 reps/side
Supinated Pull Up Isometric; 10 sec

C) Gymnastics HOT START (10-12 min):
Every 2:30 x 4-5 sets
25 Feet HS Walk or 2 Wall Walks
7 Strict L Pullup or 7 Strict Tucked Pull Up
25 Feet HS Walk or 2 Wall Walks
10/8 Cal Row @ HIGH Effort (male/female)
Effort Note:
Adjust pace as needed to prioritize high quality reps on the gymnastics movements.

D) Strength Intensity (15 min):
1 1/4 Close-Grip Bench Press
4 Working Sets; rest 2 minutes
Warm-Up Set - 5 reps @ 20X1 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 5 reps @ 20X1 - Easy
Working Set 1 - 5 @ 20X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 5 @ 20X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 5 @ 20X1 - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - Remove the 1/4 Rep and perform Max reps of Close-Grip Bench Press @ Set 1 weight.
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - Scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

E) Strength Balance (10 min):
3 sets
Barbell Skullcrusher; 10 reps @20X0
rest 30 sec
Reverse Barbell Curl; 10 reps @20X0
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1
Loading Note:
Aim for each set to be close to failure.

F) GRINDER Conditioning (12 min):
For Time @ Sustainable Pace
8 KB Turkish Get Ups Right Arm 53/35# or 35/26#
50m KB Farmers Carry 53/35# or 35/26#
20/16 Calorie Row (male/female)
50m KB Farmers Carry 53/35# or 35/26#
20/16 Calorie Row
50m KB Farmers Carry 53/35# or 35/26#
8 KB Turkish Get Ups Left Arm 53/35# or 35/26#
*Time Cap - 12mins
Effort Note:
These conditioning pieces are exploring challenging KB weights and movements like the GetUp and the Windmill over this 6-week cycle. Move at a controlled pace and slow down to make sure you execute the more complex movements correctly.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Forward Shoulder Wall Circles; 10 reps/side
Banded Shoulder Flexion Stretch; 30 sec
Banded Shoulder Extension Stretch; 30 sec

Saturday February 28, 2026

Week 3 Day 6 - Persist PERFORM

A) Daily Focus Notes: Alphabet Soup
This conditioning section is a fan favorite, and for good reason. The simple movements and unique format are great for improving the cardiovascular system and learning a lot about pacing.
Short on Time? Perform 2 sets of Strength Intensity 1.

B) Warmup (8 min):
3 Rounds
90 sec Cardio of Choice
Forward Lunge; 6/side
Goblet Good Morning; 10 reps

C) Speed Strength - Clean (15 min):
1-2 Sets (with Empty Barbell)
10 Romanian Deadlift
10 Strict Press
10 Front Squat
10 sec Squatting Quad Clean Grip Hold
10 sec Front Rack Hold
10 sec Front Squat Hold
+
5 sets; rest 90 sec between sets
1 Clean Pull + 1 Low Hang Clean + 1 Front Squat
Sets 1-2: Easy
Set 3-4: Moderate
Set 5: Challenging

D) Strength Intensity Giant Set (18 min):
4 sets
Goblet Cyclist Squat; 6-8 reps @22X1 Tempo
rest 30 sec
Single Leg Hand Support DB RDL; 5-7 reps/side @30X0
rest 30 sec
Single Arm DB Suitcase Drop Lunge; 10 reps/side
rest 2 min and back to 1.
Loading Note:
For this lower body giant set, the goal is to use one DB for each set. Perform 1 warmup set to determine starting weight. Aim for the first set to be around RPE 7. Increase weight each set with the goal of an increasing RPE. For the Drop Lunge, perform all reps on one side before switching to the other side. RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - Scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

E) Alphabet Soup (20-25 minutes):
4 Sets:
A. 8 KB Snatch/arm 53/35#
B. 8 Burpee Box Jumps 24/20"

C. 20/16 Cal Row (male/female)
D. 16 Wall Balls 20/14# to 10'
E. 16 Single Arm KB Overhead Walking Lunge (8/arm)
rest walk 2mins
Effort note:
Changing the exercise order each set requires good pacing and a better understanding of the demands of each individual movement. Follow this order:
Set 1 - ABCDE
Set 2 - EDCBA
Set 3 - CDEAB
Set 4 - BAEDC

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Half Split Hip Hinge; 6-8 reps/side
Weighted Ankle Stretch; 30 sec/side
Bottom of Squat Hold; 30 sec

Sunday March 1, 2026

Week 3 Day 7 - Persist PERFORM

The 3/60/10 Formula

If you're training 5 days per week and thriving, keep at it. We made the 5 day tracks in Persist for people who love to be in the gym.

If that's not you, guess what - it's not me right now either.

The 3/60/10 Formula is a general guideline that works great for most people for exactly how much movement, and what kind, you need to look good and move well. I've been following it for months and it works a treat.

3 days in the gym per week (Persist PUMP LIFT or PUMP CONDITION was made for this)

60 minutes of cardio total per week (The conditioning workouts in Persist, the Active Recovery days, the 30/30 or Aerobic 40 cardio workouts you can find in the Additional Resources section of the app, or any cardio you like - all at once or broken up throughout the week.)

10k steps per day (Work up to it gradually if you're not there already.)

With this formula I recover well and hit the gym HARD. I stay active every day. And you can too.

If you've been burning the candle at both ends and considering dropping down a training day or two, you have my full permission to try it. Message us any time if you need some support.

With love,
Marcus

Minimalist

Monday February 23, 2026

Week 3 Day 1 - Persist MINIMALIST

A) Daily Focus Notes: Supporting Player Shoulder Muscles
If you want a big bench, stronger pressing, and more Pull Ups, then work on improving the muscles that support your shoulders as well as your shoulders directly. The Strength Balance section today targets some of these supporting muscles with the goal of bringing more balance and capacity to the entire area.
Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance

B) Warmup (8 min):
3 Rounds
90 sec Cardio of Choice
Half Kneeling DB Windmill; 5 reps/side
Bent Over Scap Retractions; 10 reps with 2 sec pause

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
DB Push Press
4 Working Sets; rest 90 sec
Warm-Up Set - 8 reps @ 21X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 8 reps @ 21X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 8 reps @ 21X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 8 reps @ 21X1 - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - Max Unbroken reps @ 20X0 - RPE 10 (NO PAUSES - Same weight as Set 3)
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (15 min):
3 sets
Pronated Strict Pull Up; 6-8 reps @30X1
rest 30sec
Flat Bench DB Fly; 10-12 reps @20X0
rest 30sec
DB Full Raise; 10-12 reps @20X0
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1
Loading Note:
Aim for each set to be close to failure.

E) Upper Body Grinder (15 min time cap):
5 Rounds For Time
8 Wtd Hanging Knee Tuck 25/15# or 15/10#
6 Burpee
4 Wall Walks or 6 Inchworm Push Ups
15m/side Single Arm Farmers Walk
Effort Note:
The movements require a slow and steady grind for completion. Try not hit failure too early into the workout on the upper body movements.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Half Split Hip Hinge; 6-8 reps/side
Weighted Ankle Stretch; 30 sec/side
Bottom of Squat Hold; 30 sec

Tuesday February 24, 2026

Week 3 Day 2 - Persist MINIMALIST

A) Daily Focus Notes: DB Positioning
Every time you change your dumbbell position for a squat or hinge, you impact the muscles that support the pelvis. Notice in the Strength Balance section how these small position changes feel in your hips as you naturally brace to support each movement.
Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance or Conditioning

B) Warm Up (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
+

3 Sets
15 sec Cardio Sprint
Single Leg Hand Support DB RDL; 6-8 reps/side
Body Row; 12-15 reps

C) Strength Intensity (15 min): DB Sumo Deadlift
DB Sumo Deadlift
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min between sets
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 21X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 8 reps @ 21X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 8 reps @ 21X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 8 reps @ 21X1 - RPE 9
Loading Note:
The tempo prescription for today has a brief pause in the bottom position, emphasizing control in the most challenging position.

D) Strength Balance (15 min):
3 sets
Goblet Cyclist Squat; 8 reps @33X1
rest 30 sec
Single Arm DB Suitcase Drop Lunge; 10 reps/side
rest 2 min and back to 1.
Loading Note:
For this lower body superset, the goal is to use one DB for each set. Perform 1 warmup set to determine starting weight. Aim for the first set to be around RPE 7. Increase weight each set with the goal of an increasing RPE. For the Drop Lunge, perform all reps on one side before switching to the other side.

E) Lower Body Conditioning (15-20 min):
2-3 Rounds For Time
600m Run
30 Squat Jump
25 V Ups OR Tuck Ups
20 Alternating Bodyweight Russian Step Up 24/20"
*20 min time cap.
Effort Note:
Bodyweight movements require lower muscle contraction, allowing you to continue to move under higher perception of fatigue. Try to not stop moving, even if you have to reduce the pace.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Slantboard Jefferson Pulse; 30 sec
Half Kneeling Hip Flexor Stretch; 30 sec/side
Shinbox Heel Touch; 5 reps/side

Wednesday February 25, 2026

Week 3 Day 3 - Persist MINIMALIST

A) Active Recovery Work (30 min): Goal: Complete 30 minutes of low-intensity steady-state movement today. You can get out for a 30-minute walk, hike on some moderate terrain, or if you like to bike or swim, have at it.

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):
Thoracic Mobility
Segmented Cat Cow x 5 reps
Childs Pose Lat Stretch x 30 sec/side
Sidelying Thoracic Rotation x 5 reps/side with 5 sec hold
T Spine Can Opener x 1-2 min
Banded Shoulder Extension x 1 min
Active Banded Shoulder Extension x 5 reps
Yoga Push Up x 5 reps

Thursday February 26, 2026

Week 3 Day 4 - Persist MINIMALIST

A) Daily Focus Notes: Bench for Triceps
The Bench Press is often viewed as a chest exercise, but happens to be one of the best tricep exercises you can do. The Triceps are forced to go through a large range of motion with a lot of weight, even while being supported by the pecs. The Narrow DB Bench Press is a subtle variation that forces even a little more tricep and less chest. Press the DBs together and keep the elbows in at the side.
Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
3 Sets

15 sec Cardio Sprint
Push Up with Shoulder Tap; 4-5 reps/side
Supinated Pull Up Isometric; 10 sec

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
DB Narrow Grip Bench Press
4 Working Sets; rest 2 minutes
Warm-Up Set - 8 reps @ 20X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 10 @ 20X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 10 @ 20X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 10 @ 20X1 - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - Max reps of Narrow Bench Press @ Set 1 weight.
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - Scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (10 min):
3 sets
DB Rolling Skullcrusher; 10 reps @20X0
rest 30 sec
DB Reverse Curl; 10 reps @20X0
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1
Loading Note:
Aim for each set to be close to failure.

E) Push Pull Sprint (12 min):
12min Continuous Clock
2 Shuttle Run
6-10 Plyo Push Ups or Hand Release Push Ups
2 Shuttle Run
16-20 Alternating Single Arm DB Hang Snatch 50/35# or 35/20# (male/female)
*Shuttle Run: Mark two points 10m apart. 1 rep = there and back.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Forward Shoulder Wall Circles; 10 reps/side
Banded Shoulder Flexion Stretch; 30 sec
Banded Shoulder Extension Stretch; 30 sec

Friday February 27, 2026

Week 3 Day 5 - Persist MINIMALIST

A) Daily Focus Notes: B Stance Hip Thrust
This exercise needs your attention so that you don't compensate by using the bottom supporting leg or overarching the low back. Try to avoid these faults so you can keep the tension on the glutes. Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance or Conditioning.

B) Warmup (8 min):
3 Rounds
90 sec Cardio of Choice
Forward Lunge; 6/side
Goblet Good Morning; 10 reps

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
DB Front Squat
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 minutes
Warm-Up Set - 6 reps @ 33X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 6 @ 33X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 6 @ 33X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 6 @ 33X1 - RPE 9
Loading Note:
Prioritize a quality pause and bottom position during all sets today. For your working sets, you'll take 3 seconds to get down into the bottom position, hold tight for 3 seconds at the bottom, explode up (X), then pause for 1 second at the top. The reps have decreased, but the time under tension (tempo) has increased. Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
B Stance DB Hip Thrust; 6 reps/side
rest 30-60 sec
Hand Support Suitcase Single Leg Calf Raise; 10-12 reps/side @20X0
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1
Loading Note:
Perform 1 warmup set for each movement to determine the starting weight. Aim for the first set to be RPE 7 and then increase weight each set.

E) Functional Pump Conditioning (12 min):
Every 4mins x 3 Sets
8-12 DB Power Clean 50/35# (male/female)
8-12 DB Front Squat 50/35#

Run 150m
Effort Note:
The goal is to find reps and weights that allow you to finish these sets in around 3mins, giving you 1min to rest before you begin again. If you are unsure about how long this will take, then I recommend starting with the lower rep range and adding more reps or weight as you go if you are finishing too quickly and easily.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Half Split Hip Hinge; 6-8 reps/side
Weighted Ankle Stretch; 30 sec/side
Bottom of Squat Hold; 30 sec

Saturday February 28, 2026

Week 3 Day 6 - Persist MINIMALIST

A) Active Recovery Work (40 min):
Part 1: 20 min timer (continuous movement):
200m Row or Jog
then stop and do the following:
20 sec Side Plank Right
20 sec Side Plank Left
4 Standing KB or Bodyweight Windmill Right
4 Standing KB or Bodyweight Windmill Left
*return to Row or Jog and repeat
then
Part 2: 20 min timer (continuous movement):
200m Row or Jog
then stop and do the following:
10 Underswitch to Crab Reach
15m Quadruped Crawl
20sec Bent Hollow Hold
*return to Row or Jog and repeat

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):
Hip Internal Rotation
Hip Sleeper Stretch x 1-2 min/side
Shinbox Hip IR Stretch x 1-2 min/side
Shinbox Active Hip IR Liftoff x 10 reps/side

Half Kneeling Weight Shift x 10 reps/side
Squat Hip Rotations x 10 reps
Supine Active Hip Internal Rotation x 5-10 reps/side

Sunday March 1, 2026

Week 3 Day 7 - Persist MINIMALIST

The 3/60/10 Formula

If you're training 5 days per week and thriving, keep at it. We made the 5 day tracks in Persist for people who love to be in the gym.

If that's not you, guess what - it's not me right now either.

The 3/60/10 Formula is a general guideline that works great for most people for exactly how much movement, and what kind, you need to look good and move well. I've been following it for months and it works a treat.

3 days in the gym per week (Persist PUMP LIFT or PUMP CONDITION was made for this)

60 minutes of cardio total per week (The conditioning workouts in Persist, the Active Recovery days, the 30/30 or Aerobic 40 cardio workouts you can find in the Additional Resources section of the app, or any cardio you like - all at once or broken up throughout the week.)

10k steps per day (Work up to it gradually if you're not there already.)

With this formula I recover well and hit the gym HARD. I stay active every day. And you can too.

If you've been burning the candle at both ends and considering dropping down a training day or two, you have my full permission to try it. Message us any time if you need some support.

With love,
Marcus